



HOW TO MAKE PLUM CHUTNEY

Ingredients

- * 250g (9oz) onions
- * 1kg (2¼lb) plums
- * 350g (12oz) cooking apples
- * 125g (4½oz) raisins
- * 300g (10½oz) light brown soft sugar
- * 1 tsp sea salt
- * 1 tsp each allspice, cinnamon, & coriander, freshly ground if possible
- * 1 dried chilli or ½ tsp dried chilli flakes
- * 1 tsp fennel seeds (optional)
- * 600ml (1 pint) white wine or cider vinegar

Equipment

- * Sharp chopping knife
- * Chopping board
- * Stainless steel preserving pan or large, heavy-based, stainless steel saucepan
- * Large wooden spoon
- * Funnel
- * Ladle
- * Jars with vinegar-proof lids, or with cellophane covers and elastic bands
- * Discs of waxed paper



1 Peel and finely slice the onions. Halve the plums, remove their stones, and cut the fruit into quarters. Core, peel, and roughly dice the cooking apples into bite-sized pieces. You can use slightly overripe or slightly imperfect produce, but carefully cut out and discard any bruised or damaged parts. The quality of the chutney depends on this kind of meticulous approach.



2 Put all the ingredients into a preserving pan or a large, heavy-based, stainless steel saucepan and bring slowly to the boil, stirring to dissolve the sugar. It's important to use a stainless steel pan and not a brass, copper, or iron pan, as these metals will react with the vinegar and give the finished chutney a metallic taste.